

## PART C: Scale Thinking

### 1. What Breaks First – The Single Most Dangerous Failure Point

The COO's informal coordination loop.

Right now, the COO connects with 12 managers daily. Verbally. Personally. They know who is stuck, who is hiding a problem, who needs a push, and who is reliable. This works at 2 CDMO projects because the COO can hold it all in their head.

At 8 projects, with 3-4 new analysts added, this breaks – not because the COO becomes less capable, but because **\*\*the system was never a system. It was a person.\*\***

Here's why this is the most dangerous failure point and not something else:

It's invisible until it snaps. A tracker gap is visible. A missed deadline shows up. But when the COO's informal loop degrades – when they start missing signals because there are too many signals – nobody announces it. Projects just quietly start slipping. OOS results sit unresolved a day longer than they should. A manager stops flagging problems because they didn't hear back the last two times.

Everything else depends on it. The unified tracker works because the COO validates it daily. The forum stays clean because the COO redirects issues. The HODs stay accountable because the COO is the consequence. Remove that daily human loop and every other system weakens simultaneously.

New analysts make it worse before they make it better. **\*\*** Three new analysts means three people the COO now has to calibrate, align, and course-correct – on top of 8 projects. Without a structured information architecture, the COO becomes the bottleneck for their own organization's growth.

### 2. The System to Build Now, at 2 Projects

Build the COO's informal loop into a structured daily operating rhythm – before the volume arrives.

The goal is to make the COO's current mental model of the organization visible, scannable, and transferable – so it doesn't live only in one person's head.

What this builds at 2 projects that pays off at 8:

- The habit of daily analyst-owned updates is established before volume makes it feel optional
  - The COO shifts from calling people to scanning a digest – freeing bandwidth before they need it
  - When analysts 2, 3, and 4 join, they inherit a live template – they don't start from scratch
  - At 8 projects, the COO still reads one email. It now has 8 rows instead of 2.
- The behavior scales. The cognitive load doesn't.

This goes into a shared doc – not emailed, not presented. Just logged. At 2 projects it takes 10 minutes. At 8 projects with 4 analysts it becomes the institutional memory that prevents every new person from reinventing context from zero.

### 3. What You Automate, What You Keep Human, and Why

This is a judgment call about where machines are better than people and where people are irreplaceable. The line is drawn at trust and interpretation.

Daily digest email to COO

Power Automate pulls Red and Amber rows from the Sheet each morning and sends a formatted summary. No human should be spending 20 minutes compiling a status update that a script can do in 20 seconds. This is pure information routing – no judgment required.

72-hour stale row alert

If an analyst hasn't updated their row in 72 hours, Power Automate sends them a WhatsApp message. Not from the COO. Not from you. From the system. The distinction matters – it's a reminder, not a reprimand. It also removes you from the role of chaser, which protects your relationship with the analysts and HODs.

OOS escalation trigger

If a row is marked Red and remains Red for 48 hours without a resolution note, Power Automate flags it directly to the COO. No human needs to decide whether to escalate – the rule is pre-set. This is where automation prevents things from quietly slipping.

Weekly summary for CEO

Claude takes the Friday analyst notes and generates a one-page narrative summary – open items, resolved items, patterns across projects. Structured prompt, consistent output, zero additional work for any human. The CEO gets diagnostic data without attending anything.